What is LibRate?

Talk to the people around you — with or without internet.

Document 1 of 4 · Version 1.0 · Android 8.0 and newer · Free software

In one paragraph

LibRate is a free, anonymous messenger for Android that **does not need the internet**. Phones running LibRate find each other over Bluetooth and pass messages along from phone to phone, so a crowd becomes its own network. When any phone nearby does have a connection, the same messages also travel through small public relay servers to reach people further away. There are no accounts, no phone numbers, no company servers and nothing to sign up for. It was built in a single night after BitChat was banned in India ahead of a protest.

Why it exists

During large gatherings the mobile network is often the first thing to fail — switched off by order, overloaded by the crowd, or quietly monitored. Ordinary messengers stop working at exactly the moment people most need to coordinate: finding each other, warning about danger, agreeing where to go. LibRate is designed for that moment. It keeps working when the network does not, and it never asks who you are.

What makes it different

No account	Your identity is a cryptographic key created on your phone the first time you open the app. No one issues it, no one can suspend it, and nothing links it to your name or number.
Offline first	Messages hop between phones over Bluetooth, up to 7 hops. One hop already covers everyone within ~10–30 m, so a dense crowd carries a message a few hundred metres with no network at all.
Online when possible	A single phone with data bridges the whole local crowd to the relays — and through them to other crowds in other cities. The two paths join automatically.
Private	Direct chats and password rooms are end-to-end encrypted. Relays and bystanders see only scrambled data.
Nothing stored elsewhere	Messages live only on your phone, encrypted. No server keeps a copy. Cloud backup is disabled on purpose.
Disposable	One tap (or typing `/wipe`) erases the identity, keys, contacts and every message. You start again as a stranger.
Text only	No photos, voice or video. Small messages travel far over Bluetooth and survive bad conditions; large files would not.
Open	The source code is public. Anyone can read it, build it, or run their own relay.

What you can do with it

- **Nearby** — one open channel for everyone within Bluetooth reach. See who is around and talk to all of them at once.
- **Rooms** — named channels (`#north-gate`), optionally protected by a password. Location rooms for your city, neighbourhood and block.
- **Groups** — rooms with a creator and admins who can remove members. Share them with a QR invite.
- **Private chats** — encrypted one-to-one conversations. Strangers appear as requests you can accept or decline.
- **People** — everyone seen in the last ten minutes, with how far away they are in hops.

Who it is for

- People at protests, marches, rallies, festivals and stadiums where networks fail.
- Volunteers and medics who need to coordinate across a crowd.
- Neighbourhoods during storms, floods and power cuts.
- Anyone who wants to talk without creating an account or handing over a phone number.

What it is not

> LibRate is not a replacement for Signal or WhatsApp in daily life — it is slower, text only, and reaches only as far as the crowd or a relay reaches. It does not hide that you are *using* it: a phone running LibRate is visible to other Bluetooth devices. It does not protect a phone that is seized unlocked. And it cannot stop the *other* person in a chat from screenshotting or sharing what you wrote.

Getting it

1. Get the APK file from someone you trust — best **phone to phone** over Bluetooth, Nearby Share or a cable. Links can be blocked; people cannot.
2. Choose `arm64-v8a` for most phones, `armeabi-v7a` for older or budget ones. If one refuses, try the other.
3. Open it. Android asks once to allow installs from this source. Then open LibRate, keep or edit your name, and tap **Allow all**.
4. Before trusting a copy, check its SHA-256 against `SHA256SUMS.txt` or a friend's copy. All genuine releases are signed with this certificate:
   `7F:05:8A:F1:48:8C:A4:0A:AF:B2:14:86:D7:7A:64:24:19:9B:00:30:BB:38:A0:44:FA:11:B7:8D:7A:78:15:B6`

Updates installed over an existing copy keep all your data. Uninstalling deletes everything, permanently.

Learn more

Document 2 explains *how it works*; document 3 walks through *the app* and the reasoning behind its choices; document 4 is the *architecture* for engineers. Questions and new download links: **keshavgithub01@gmail.com**.
